

A FIELD GUIDE TO WHAT'S NEXT

Tickle the Pig

The Games Guide



Seventeen new ways to play in the barn — pitches, fantasies,
and how each one feeds the world.

The big idea

01

The Schism Front is the meta-frame — not just another mode

Today the Greedy↔Giver alignment is a private number. Sum those same daily blessings, curses, and trades into one public world Tide that resolves at Judgement Day, and every short mode suddenly matters: an Oracle bet, a pageant win, a Mud-Off shift all become ways to push the front. Player behavior becomes the content — the only long-game a solo barn can sustain.

02

The mini-games are really just four cheat-proof engines

Everything async collapses into four reusable shapes. Build the engines once, reskin forever.

Server-owns-answer

Pick'em & oracles.
The server holds the truth, so a modded client can't cheat.

Shared daily seed

Same board for everyone; the server re-derives the score.
Fair leaderboards.

Co-op pot

Stake → depleting pot
→ atomic claim.
Buried Truffle in new clothes.

Async duel

Both play one shared seed, whenever.
Words-with-friends pacing.

The pages that follow: one game each. Read the pitch, feel the fantasy, picture the loop. 🐷

Snout Oracle

“Read the entrails of the barn: stake your snouts on what’s about to happen, and split the losers’ pot with every pig who saw it coming.”

THE FANTASY

You are the barn's soothsayer. Twice a day a question hangs in the air — will the Givers out-bless the Greedy before sundown? will more truffles get dug than yesterday? — and you put your snouts where your snout is. When the bell rings and the oracle speaks, the pigs who read the omens right carve up the pot the wrong-guessers left behind. It is gambling stripped of the house: no snout is ever minted or burned by the oracle, only moved from the wrong to the right.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Open the Snout Oracle card (lives on the Barn home, near the Trough/Truffle social row).
- 2 Pick one option and confirm a fixed buy-in (default 20 snouts, mirroring the truffle/drive stake size). Snouts are debited atomically; your pick is locked into the round ledger.
- 3 Watch the herd's lean shift as others bet (a read-only tally, refreshed on focus — no realtime authority).
- 4 After lock_at the round is sealed. The next time anyone opens the Oracle (or a cron tick fires), the server resolves it from data it already holds and the round flips to resolved with an outcome.

Depends on: Shipped primitives only — bury_truffle atomic debit, item_drives escrow/refund, daily_shop() date-seed, dig_truffle FOR UPDATE depletion, grant_tickles, INLINE system_announcements. Front-resolvable catalog rows additionally need the Schism Front (profiles.faction) once it ships, but ship disabled until then — the mode is fully standalone on day one.



Pig's Daily Riddle (Slopword)

"One hidden farm word a day, six tries, green-amber-grey — solve it, brag the emoji-snout grid to your Sounder, and let the barn tell you how clever your snout is."

THE FANTASY

You are the clever pig who cracks the day's riddle before the rest of the Sounder. Every morning the barn whispers one secret word, and you have six muddy guesses to root it out. Solving in two feels like a tiny triumph you have to show off; the spoiler-safe emoji-snout grid is the brag, and watching a friend's grid trickle into the feed is the reason you come back tomorrow.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Open the Riddle card on the Barn (or a Riddle tab). It shows a fresh 6x5 board, today's UTC date, and your remaining-tries state restored from the server if you started earlier.
- 2 (Optional entry cost.) MVP is free — entry is the hook, not a sink. A tiny snout fee (profiles.counter, burned via the bury_truffle debit idiom) is a v2 toggle, not the launch state.
- 3 Type a 5-letter guess from a client-packaged allow-list (instant UX validation, no round-trip to reject typos). Submit.
- 4 `submit_daily_guess(p_guess)` runs server-side, recomputes the color pattern against the secret, persists the guess into your attempt row, increments a server-side guess counter, and returns only the color pattern (green/amber/grey) — never the answer, never the remaining letters.

Depends on: nothing — standalone. Pairs naturally with Snout Oracle (ships the same entry/resolve/idempotent-claim spine) but does not require it.



The Beauty Pageant (Style Score)

"Dress Rosie to the day's theme and strut the catwalk — the server reads your worn look, scores it, and crowns a dated best-dressed Ribbon no snout can ever buy."

THE FANTASY

You are a doting owner walking your pig down the catwalk at the County Fair. Each morning a new theme is announced — today the judges want GLAM, tomorrow they want RUGGED — and you raid your closet to assemble the most on-theme strut Rosie has ever worn. The thrill is the reveal: you lock your look, the judges deliberate overnight, and you wake to find out whether your pig took the dated Ribbon. It is identity expression with a daily verdict — your taste, scored.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Open the Pageant card on the Barn. It shows today's theme (one of GLAM / CHARM / SHARP / CLEVER / RUGGED) and a short flavor line ("The judges are feeling Glam today — bring the sparkle").
- 2 Tap through to the Closet (the existing equip surface). Swap worn items across the 6 scored slots to chase the theme.
- 3 Tap Enter the Pageant. The server re-reads your live worn slots, computes your authoritative style_score, snapshots your look, and locks your entry for the day.
- 4 (v2 only) Spend a small daily vote budget rating blind rival entries on the catwalk.

Depends on: the hats catalog (public.hats + category/rarity), the equip-slot columns on profiles (active_hat_id, active_glasses_id, active_mask_id, active_aura_id, active_held_id, active_background_id — see constants/slots.ts), grant_tickles (the only over-cap-safe faucet), the daily_shop() date-seed idiom, user_hats + ON CONFLICT DO NOTHING, inline system_announcements, the resolve_expired_drives lazy-resolution pattern, the alignment_leaderboard UNION ALL shape (for public_pig_look). Voting v2 additionally needs friend_ids() and grant_season_xp.



The Mud-Off (Teams)

“Pick a side — Hilltoppers or Valleyfolk — and roll your whole pen into one filthy, glorious turf war. Tickle hard, toss snouts in the pit, and let the muddiest, busiest faction win.”

THE FANTASY

You are not a lone pig grinding your own bank anymore — you've thrown in with a tribe. Every tickle you tap and every snout you toss into the pit is a shovelful of mud heaped onto your faction's pile, and across the next two weeks you watch your side's standing slosh up and down against the rivals on the hill (or down in the valley).

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Once per cycle: open the Mud-Off card, pick Hilltoppers or Valleyfolk, lock it in for the cycle (free re-pick when the next cycle opens).
- 2 Daily (the nest of the loop): tickle Rosie as you already do for the home loop.
- 3 Optional, any day: toss snouts into your faction's pit to convert spend into a capped muck boost — a deliberate investment that nudges the average but can't buy the win.
- 4 Bi-weekly settle (the stakes): at the 14-day UTC boundary a single cron tick resolves the Mud-Off.

Depends on: ships the `profiles.faction` column itself (clone of `choose_allegiance`, `supabase/migrations/20260585000000_world_cup_allegiance.sql`); otherwise standalone — passive contribution rides the already-shipped `tickles_earned` monotonic counter, so it needs no new tap-path write.



Sounder Showdown (Team Pageant)

"Dress your pig, strut for your pen — a small tidy sounder can out-style a big messy one."

THE FANTASY

You are a proud member of a pen, and tonight is the catwalk. You dress your pig to today's theme, lock the look, and your fashion sense becomes a point of pride for your whole faction — not because you grinded harder than anyone, but because your taste lifted the pen's average. A handful of well-dressed Hilltoppers can shame a mob of careless Valleyfolk. It is belonging without grind: turnout and good taste, not headcount, win the day.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Daily (the act): Open the Showdown card. See today's date-seeded style theme (e.g. "GLAM day"). Dress Rosie in your closet, then tap Enter the Showdown.
- 2 The effort ladder (placement-independent): Entering at all advances your lifetime-entry band (bronze/silver/gold).
- 3 Nightly (the stakes): At the daily UTC boundary `resolve_showdown_day()` computes each pen's per-capita score, picks the winning faction, grants the winners modest tickles + season XP + a dated Ribbon, and `INLINEs` a personal dispatch ("The catwalk verdict is in...").
- 4 Seasonal (the meta): Showdown is one front in the Schism Front war (see How it composes).

Depends on: the `profiles.faction` column (Hilltoppers/Valleyfolk, lock-once — clone of `choose_allegiance`) AND the Style Score model (`hats.style_*` columns + `style_score()` + `public_pig_look()`), shipped + validated by the solo Pageant). Neither exists in any migration today — both appear ONLY in the exploration doc. Build Showdown before either and you are really building that prereq plus Showdown; re-scope as XL.



Snout Drop (Truffle Plinko)

"Bury a pot of snouts, hand each friend ONE pig to drop down the peg board — the truffle they unearth at the bottom is their cut of your buried treasure."

THE FANTASY

You are the generous host who buried a fat pot of snouts and rigged a peg board over it, then invited the Sounder to come try their luck. Each friend is the hopeful gambler-pig holding a single trotter on the drop lever: pick a lane, let the pig tumble through the pegs, and watch where it lands.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 From your Barn, tap "Set out a Snout Drop" and stake a pot of {10, 20, 50} snouts (verbatim the `bury_truffle(p_amount)` choice set).
- 2 Check on it anytime via the host status sheet: pot total, how much remains, and the list of friends who've dropped (the `truffle_status()` diggers list, re-skinned).
- 3 One active Snout Drop per host at a time (`truffles_one_active_per_host` partial unique index). When the pot empties, you can set out a fresh one.
- 4 Visit a friend's Barn. If they have an active Snout Drop, the peg board renders over the buried pot.

Depends on: nothing — standalone. Pure reuse of the shipped Buried Truffle stack (`bury_truffle`, `truffles`, `truffle_digs`, `dig_truffle`), `daily_shop()`'s date seed, `shift_alignment`, and the `INLINE` `system_announcements` notify pattern.



Mud Putt (Daily Pin)

"Every pig putts the same mud green today — sink Rosie's ball in the fewest swings and top your Sounder's leaderboard before the green washes away at midnight."

THE FANTASY

You're a pig lining up a putt on today's one-and-only mud green. The whole Sounder is squinting at the same slope, the same gusty wind, the same pin — so a clean two-stroke sink isn't luck, it's a read you nailed that your friends didn't. It's the cozy daily-ritual itch of Wordle (one shared board, one shot at glory, resets at midnight) wearing mini-golf's "ohhh, so close" drama.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Open the Mud Putt card (on the Barn/play surface).
- 2 Pay the entry: a small SNOUT sink (`profiles.counter`, default 5 snouts), debited atomically the same way `bury_truffle()` charges. One ranked round per UTC day.
- 3 Take up to 4 swings. Each swing is a drag-to-aim + power gesture; the client runs a local preview sim so the ball rolls on screen (juice/feel only — the number it produces is thrown away).
- 4 The ball either sinks or you run out of swings.

Depends on: nothing hard-blocking — standalone, but ideally ships after Snout Oracle + Slopword have proven the entry/faucet/notify spine. Reuses shipped primitives only.



Sounder Stampede

“The whole Sounder thunders toward the same pile of slop — sink your snout in before the barn snorts it dry.”

THE FANTASY

You are one pig in a stampeding Sounder, and there is a fresh pellet pile in the field that the whole herd can smell. Every lunge you take is a gamble: sink your snout in now and you get a fat mouthful, but if you wait the pile shrinks as everyone else gorges — and the looming Barn is also eating the pile out from under all of you.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Daily: Open the Stampede card on the home screen.
- 2 Lunge: Spend SNOUTS to lunge. Each lunge is one atomic claim against the shared pot — you get a bite whose size the server computes from how full the pile still is. Bigger pile = bigger bite.
- 3 Tension: Between your sessions, the barn keeps eating (drain is computed from elapsed real time, not a cron — see Mechanics) and other pigs keep lunging. Come back and the pile is smaller.
- 4 Empty / end-of-day: When the pile hits zero (drained or fully eaten) OR the UTC day rolls over, the round settles.

Depends on: Buried Truffle primitives (bury_truffle / truffle_digs / dig_truffle), trough/bounty_trough shared-goal bar, daily_shop() date-seed pattern, grant_tickles() faucet, profiles.counter (SNOUTS). Standalone as a mode — reuses, does not modify, those systems.



The Slop Cauldron

"Toss your snouts in the village cauldron — when the whole Sounder makes it boil over, everyone scoops a tickle reward and a fresh pot bubbles up."

THE FANTASY

You are one of many pigs gathered around a great communal slop cauldron, tipping in handfuls of snouts and watching the level creep up toward the rim. It is Cookie Clicker's "number goes up" feeling — except the number is everyone's, and the satisfying part is being the snout that tips it over the edge for the whole barn. When it boils over, the village shares the spoils and a new pot starts bubbling.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 The daily/twice-daily action. Open the Cauldron card (lives in the Shop alongside the Trough, or on the Barn Exterior).
- 2 Nesting into the week. A single global Cauldron is alive at a time. It typically takes the active community a few days of pours to fill.
- 3 The payoff moment.
- 4 Seasonal frame.

Depends on: `donate_to_drive` / `open_item_drive` (the `item_drives` schema + Sounder-scoped `donate` path), the `dig_truffle` FOR UPDATE depleting-pot + clamp-to-remaining pattern, `grant_tickles` / `settle_tickles` over-cap faucet, `daily_shop()` / `shop_resets_in_seconds()` date-seed helpers, the TroughSection bar UI + `my_drives` read shape, `shift_alignment`, `grant_season_xp` first-of-day XP, `are_friends()`, and the `INLINE` `system_announcements` notify idiom.



"Strap Rosie to the Slop-Rocket, pick your launch, and see how far a pig can fly — one glorious hurl a day."

You are a backyard rocket engineer who has, with great affection and zero ethics, bolted a slop-fueled rocket to a pig. Every morning you get exactly one shot to fling Rosie across the seeded sky of the day — read the gusts, time the pre-charge, place your snort-boosts, and watch her arc toward the horizon. Between hurls you sink snouts into the Slop-Rocket upgrade tree, the numbers-go-up treadmill that makes tomorrow's launch reach farther.

- 1 Daily (the hurl): Once per UTC day a shared seed (derived exactly like `daily_shop()`: `abs(hashtext('hoghurl' || current_date)))` fixes today's launch conditions for everyone — ramp angle bands, a gust profile, and a bounce-pad map.
- 2 Resolve (lazy, at lock): When the daily round's `lock_at` passes (next UTC midnight), the next player to touch the round triggers a lazy settle (no cron — same lazy-resolve pattern the Oracle/drives use).
- 3 Between hurls (the treadmill): Spend snouts on Slop-Rocket Upgrade tiers — server-owned, capped stat ladders (ramp power, gust resistance, bounce elasticity, extra snort-boost slot).
- 4 Weekly/seasonal stakes: The leaderboard resets are daily, but cumulative best-distance and total-pot-winnings feed the season.

10



Acorn Arc (Slingshot Standoff)

“Two pigs, one acorn slingshot, one windy seed — load up, let it fly whenever you like, and the barn settles who got closest to the bullseye.”

THE FANTASY

You are a barnyard sharpshooter at the slingshot line, squinting down an acorn at a target swinging in the wind. A friend in your Sounder has thrown down a snout wager on the exact same windy field, and you each get one honest shot — no live pressure, no twitch reflexes, just you, the arc, and your read of the gust. You load up whenever the mood strikes, let the acorn fly, and wait to find out whether your aim or theirs landed truer.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Daily action (the throw): Open Acorn Arc from the Barn.
- 2 You either issue a challenge to a Sounder friend or answer one waiting for you.
- 3 Both sides shoot the same per-match seeded field (target position, wind vector, obstacle layout).
- 4 On your turn you drag the slingshot — choosing one (angle, power) pair — watch your local preview arc, and commit.

Depends on: the solo shared-seed harness (Mud Putt — #4 on the shortlist) shipping first; reuses its seed + submit-tiny-input + server-re-sim plumbing. Also depends on `are_friends()` / `utils/friendships.ts` (live), the truffle pot ledger (`truffles/truffle_digs`, live), and `daily_shop()`'s seed idiom (live).



The Schism Front

“Every blessing, curse, and trade in the sounder pulls one cosmic tug-of-war between the Givers and the Goblins — and at Judgement Day the whole world tips into a Golden Age or a Reckoning.”

THE FANTASY

The fiction has always promised a cosmic schism — goblins vs angels, a Greedy ↔ Giver axis on every identity surface, a Judgement Day finale — but the war was never real: alignment is a private per-player number that sums to nothing. The Schism Front makes it real.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 The act (instant). You do what you already do — send a blessing, lay a curse, fulfill a trade, dig a friend's truffle, visit a pig. Each of those already calls `shift_alignment(uid, ±delta)`.
- 2 The morning (overnight, slow).
- 3 The heartbeat (weekly).
- 4 The climax (seasonal).

Depends on: `shift_alignment()` (the alignment chokepoint, ~15 call sites)



The Barn Almanac

"A weekly hog-mystery, told page by page by Old Saffron — and the whole sounder writes the next page just by being generous or greedy."

THE FANTASY

You are a reader of a living book that the whole barn is writing without meaning to. Every Sunday Old Saffron — the oldest, saltiest sow in the pasture — adds a chapter to The Barn Almanac, and which version of the chapter you get depends on whether the sounder has been drifting Generous or Greedy on the same gauge that decides Judgement Day.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Daily (unchanged, optional): the player tickles, blesses, curses, trades, visits — every act already calls `shift_alignment` and (under the Front) bumps `world_tide`.
- 2 Mid-week peek: the player opens the Almanac surface (a book on the Barn Exterior shelf) and re-reads the current open chapter.
- 3 Weekly (the heartbeat): Sunday's `settle_schism_week()` settle (already in the Front) also resolves the Almanac: it locks in which branch of this week's chapter became canon, writes Old Saffron's hand-authored dispatch as the chapter's epigraph, and `INLINEs` a personal "Old Saffron turned a page" announcement.
- 4 Seasonal (the climax): at Judgement Day (`finalize_season`), the mystery's finite arc resolves into one of the world-fates.

Depends on: The Schism Front (the `world_tide` singleton + nightly/weekly settle crons). The Almanac is the narrative skin on that gauge, not a separate build. If the Front isn't shipped, the Almanac's MVP carries the same two-line accumulation hook into `shift_alignment` as its own seed.



The Snout Almanac + The Hog Line

"Fill Rosie's trophy room with lore-stamped finery, then retire her into the Herd so her heirloom — and one daft trait — passes to the pig who carries your name next season."

THE FANTASY

You are a keeper of a long line of pigs, not the owner of one. Every hat you collect is a page in Rosie's world-almanac — a thing with a name and a sentence of lore — and filling shelves earns you the slow museum-curator glow of a near-complete set. Then, once a season, your pig grows old with dignity, walks out into a visible Herd of ancestors, and hands her heirloom and one inherited quirk to the next generation.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Daily (incidental): You acquire cosmetics the way you already do — `daily_shop()` buys, battle-pass/Slop-Club grants, lucky-pig drops, Schism-Front fate cosmetics, drive payouts.
- 2 Weekly (a returning pull): Set-completion is the heartbeat. The Almanac groups items into 12–18 lore sets (e.g. "The Mire Court," "Harvest Regalia").
- 3 Seasonal (the climax): At Judgement Day, after `finalize_season()` banks your alignment verdict, the Hog Line offers a once-per-season retirement: your current pig walks into the Herd (a portrait wall in the Interior), banking that season's alignment outcome as a permanent epitaph.

Depends on: hats/user_hats catalog (shipped), `finalize_season()` + season_finales (shipped), Interior/habitat slot system (shipped), system_announcements (shipped). Lands warmest after the Schism Front exists so the Front's fate cosmetics have an Almanac to be paid into — but the Almanac stands alone on the existing closet.



The Homestead

“Build a little self-tending farm out of snouts, let it cook overnight, and once a season burn it all down for permanent Rich Soil — while every harvest you tithe to the village Granary pushes the whole sounder toward the Givers.”

THE FANTASY

You are a homesteader on the edge of the pasture, coaxing a cozy little farm into existence one structure at a time — a Compost Heap, a Truffle Grove, a Mushroom Cellar — each one quietly working while you're away. You are not grinding; you are tending.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Daily (the quiet tend, ~30s): Open the Homestead (a panel reached from the Barn Exterior, beside the Garden).
- 2 The daily fork (the alignment pump): On collect you choose a tithe split — keep the harvest in your own snout counter, or divert a slice to the communal Granary.
- 3 Weekly (the heartbeat): Your structures' caps mean a fully-idle farm tops out in ~18–24h, so the real weekly move is upgrading the tree deep enough that the next tier unlocks.
- 4 Seasonal (the climax): Once per season you may hold the Harvest Festival — a prestige reset.

Depends on: alignment axis + shift_alignment (shipped); the Schism Front MVP (world_tide) as the Granary's sink target — degrades gracefully to a per-player sink if the Front isn't live yet.



The Circuit

“Walk your pig down the county-fair midway, win ribbons in every contest, and climb the pens from scrawny Piglet to Grand Champion — at your own pace, with a soft place to land.”

THE FANTASY

You are showing your pig on the county-fair circuit — not fighting a war, just trying to win ribbons and move up to a nicer pen with better company. Every contest you enter (no matter which one) earns Ribbon Points that quietly build toward the next tier, and at season's end you find out whether your pig got promoted to the Heifer Hall or the Grand Champion's Barn.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Daily / per-contest: You do what you already do — cast in the Oracle, enter the Pageant, throw down in the Mud-Off.
- 2 Weekly (the rhythm): Every Sunday a `pg_cron` tick settles your pen — a fixed cohort of ~30 players in the same tier.
- 3 Seasonal (the climax): At Judgement Day, `finalize_season()` calls `settle_circuit_season()`.

Depends on: at least one Ribbon-emitting contest must ship first (the Snout Oracle is the doc's recommended first source; the Schism Front MVP and `finalize_season()` season-key plumbing should exist). Standalone-capable on the existing alignment loop, but it RANKS modes rather than giving them collective meaning, so it must land after the Front, never before it.



The Wandering Almanac

"Rosie's barn keeps a real calendar — the seasons turn outside her window, today's forage blooms in the Garden, and a friendly stranger on the road writes you a letter you can answer with a postcard."

THE FANTASY

You live inside a barn that knows what month it is. Frost rimes the pasture in winter and clover blooms in spring; Rosie's idle pose shifts with the season; a weathered almanac on the wall turns a fresh page each morning with a single line of weather, what's in bloom, and a wry word from the road.

HOW YOU PLAY

- 1 Open the Barn Exterior. The background palette, sky, and Rosie's seasonal idle reflect the real calendar season (derived client-side from the device/current_date, no fetch).
- 2 A one-line dispatch sits on the barn wall: "June 8 — warm and bright. The clover's up."
- 3 The Garden (the existing streak surface) shows a small "in bloom this month" sprite swap — a monthly forage rotation that is purely cosmetic ambient dressing near Rosie.
- 4 A few times a week, a road-stranger letter lands in your inbox surface (a new card in the existing "while you were away" announcement modal).

Depends on: nothing — standalone; composes with the Schism Front meta-frame and the Sounder, but does not require them.

